



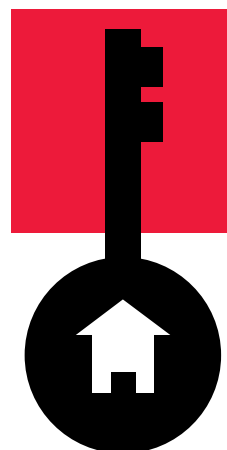
AMBANI'S NEXT BET

2023 COULD BE a crucial year for *Mukesh Ambani's* next bet—the country's vast fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) market. Backed by Reliance's massive retail and distribution network and major investment plans on increasing its warehousing capacity and supply chain efficiencies, Ambani's dream of turning Reliance into a major consumer goods player may become a reality in 2023.

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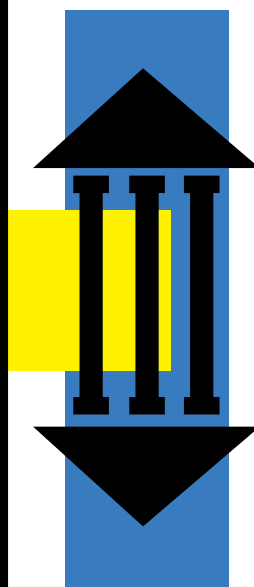
HOME-LESS BUYERS

WITH HOME LOAN interest rates and cost of construction rising, the acquisition cost of homes has surged by over 10 per cent in 2022. With the rise in raw material prices, realtors may pass on the additional burden to homebuyers, resulting in another round of price hikes of 5-10 per cent in 2023. And lending rates are expected to go up further as the RBI attempts to tame inflation.



VALUATION WALTZ

JUST LIKE THE stake sale of insurance behemoth Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), the privatisation of IDBI Bank is taking longer than initially thought. While the bidders are lining up, it is the bank's valuation that has grabbed everyone's attention. The lender is large, and if any serious player makes a bid, it could lead to an intense bidding war.



HDFC'S NEW FACE

By April 2023, mortgage giant HDFC Ltd's merger with HDFC Bank will be a reality and *Sashidhar Jagdishan*, MD and CEO of HDFC Bank, will be the new face of the group. How will Jagdishan, who honed his skills as a CFO and not as a business manager, face the challenges that the combined entity will throw up?

